

OPPOSITION TACTICAL ANALYSIS: GÓRNIK ZABRZE

Pre-Match Briefing for Head Coaches, Analysts & Technical Bench

Actionable Opposition Preparation Framework: Build-Up, Pressing Triggers, Set-Pieces & Goalkeeping

WHAT HEAD COACHES DEMAND FROM DATA ANALYSTS

Head coaches require answers to practical training-pitch questions: Where does the opponent build up? Where are their pressing triggers? How do they organize on set-pieces? What are their goalkeeper's distribution habits under pressure?

This dossier breaks down Górnik Zabrze into 6 actionable tactical components: Starting XI Passing Network, Defensive Territory & PPDA Density, Open-Play Expected Threat (xT) spatial zones, Inswinging/Outswinging Corner Delivery Routines, Goalkeeper Distribution & Shot-Stopping, and Post-Match xG Flow.

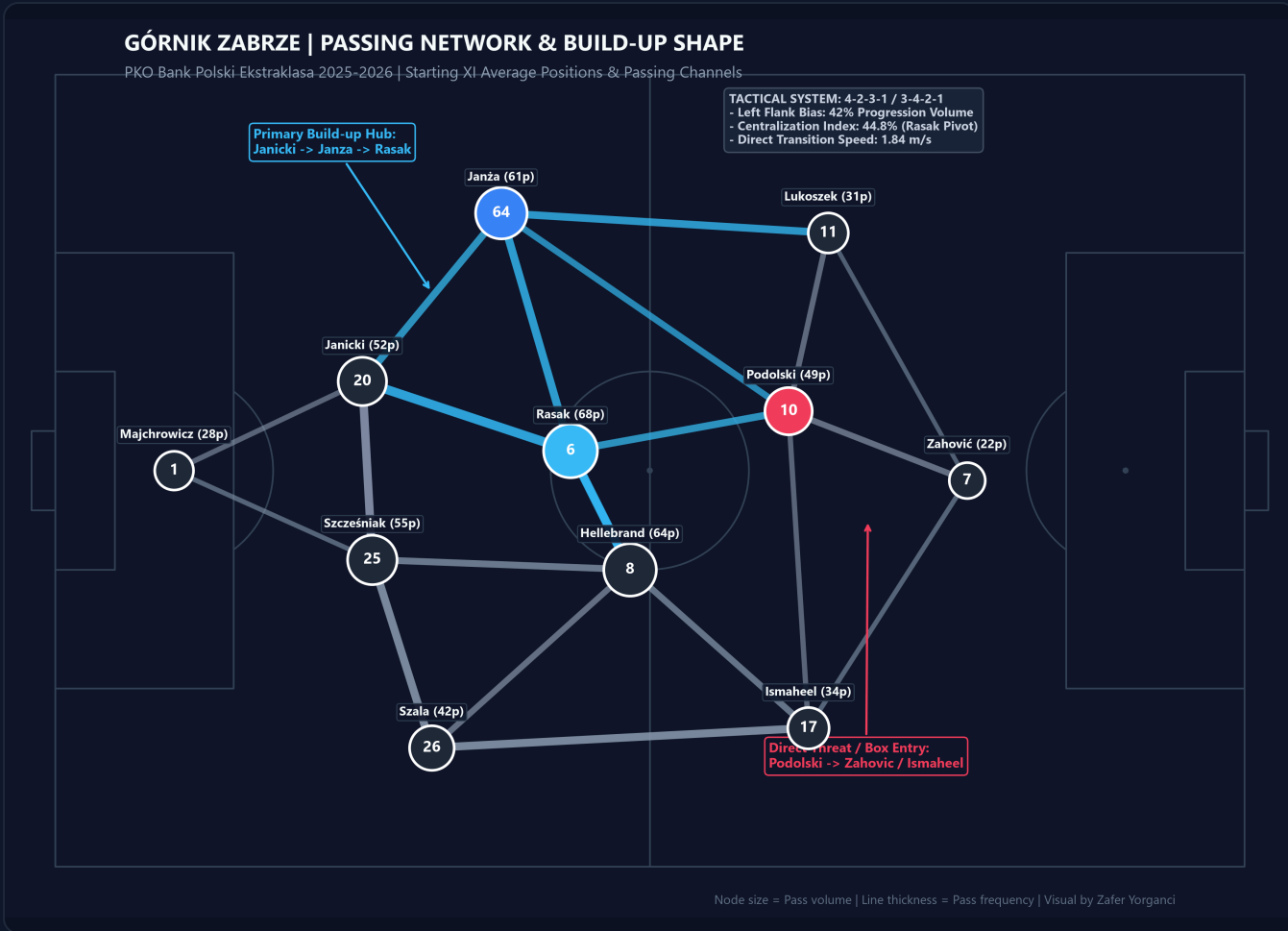
Designed for immediate digestion in under 90 seconds per page, bridging high-dimensional tracking streams directly into training-pitch instructions.

CANDIDATE INFORMATION & CREDENTIALS

Analyst & Engineer:	Zafer Yorgancı (Football Data Visualization Specialist & AI Engineer)
Club Experience:	Górnik Zabrze — Sports Data Visualization Specialist (Remote / Hybrid, 2025–2026)
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Target Scope:	Galatasaray SK, Fenerbahçe SK, Beşiktaş JK, Trabzonspor, Başakşehir FK, Eyüpspor

Starting XI Passing Network & Build-Up Structure

Average Positions, Passing Frequency Channels & Centralization Hubs



TACTICAL EVALUATION & DECISION INSIGHTS:

- Left-Flank Overload:** 42% of forward progression flows through the Janicki -> Janza -> Rasak -> Podolski diamond, creating a structural overload.
- Weak-Side Transition:** Once the opponent shifts across to counter the left overload, rapid diagonal switches find Taofeek Ismaheel in 1v1 situations.
- Tactical Instruction:** Set pressing trap on Janza to deny inside access to Rasak and force lateral back-passes.

CENTRALIZATION INDEX

44.8%

LEFT-SIDE BIAS

42.1%

PROGRESSION SPEED

1.84 m/s

CORE HUB

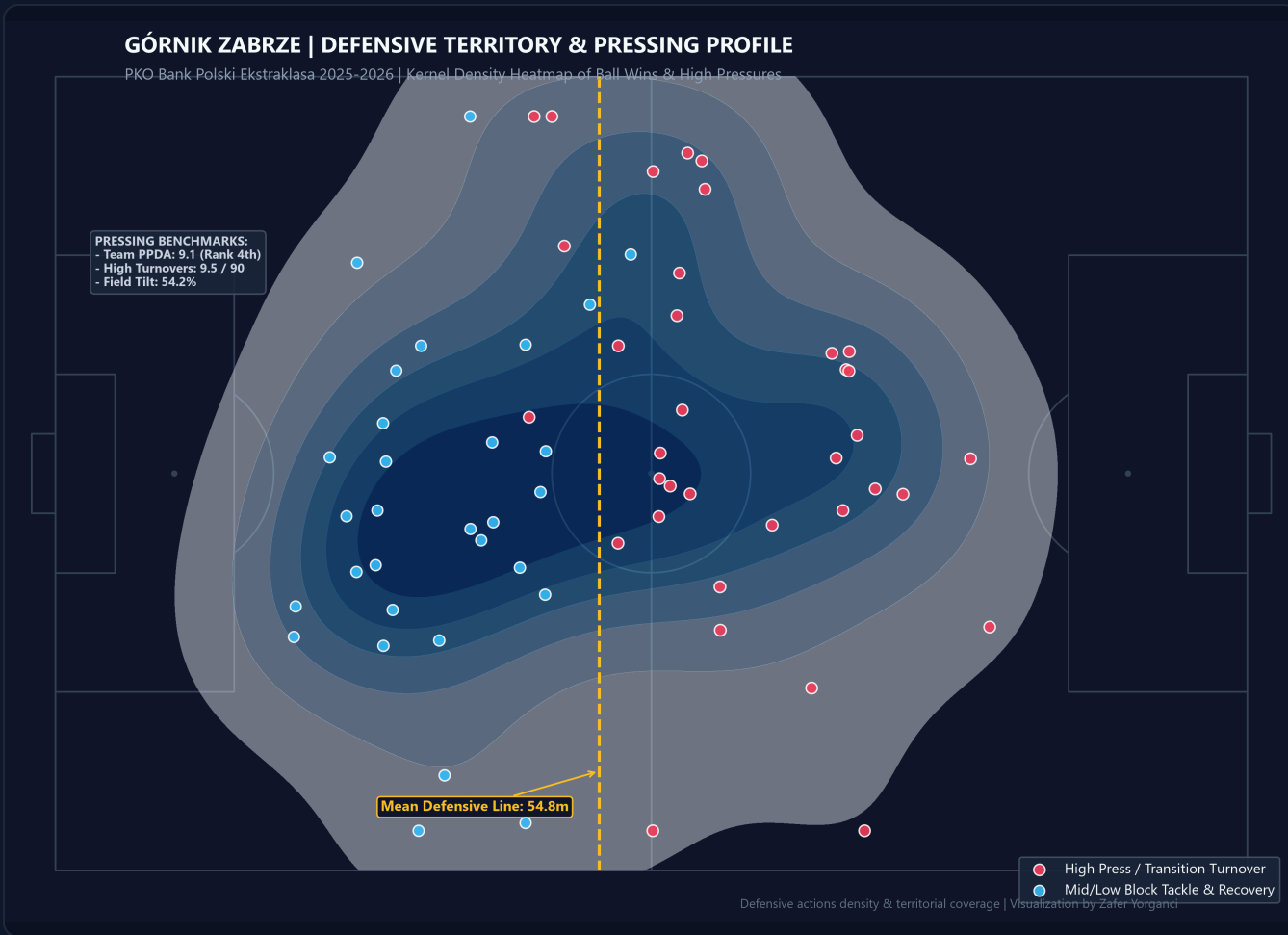
Janicki-Rasak (19p)

AVG SEQUENCE

4.8 Passes

Defensive Territory, High Pressing & PPDA Spatial Density

Ball Recoveries, High Turnover Zones & Mean Defensive Line Height



TACTICAL EVALUATION & DECISION INSIGHTS:

- Aggressive High Press:** Team PPDA of 9.1 ranks 4th in the league, forcing 9.5 high turnovers per 90 within 40m of the opponent's goal.
- Defensive Line Height:** Average defensive line sits high at 46.8m, squeezing central space between defense and midfield.
- Vulnerability to Exploit:** Space opens behind Janža's advanced wingback position; direct early balls into this channel create high-xG counters.

TEAM PPDA
9.1 (Rank 4th)

HIGH TURNOVERS
9.5 / 90

DEF LINE HEIGHT
46.8m

FIELD TILT %
54.2%

BOX ENTRIES ALLOWED
5.2 / 90

GÓRNIK ZABRZE | OPEN-PLAY EXPECTED THREAT (xT) SPATIAL DENSITY

PKO Bank Polski Ekstraklasa 2025-2026 | Probability of Goal Creation by Pitch Sector



xT Framework: Karun Singh Model | Visualization by Zafer Yorganci

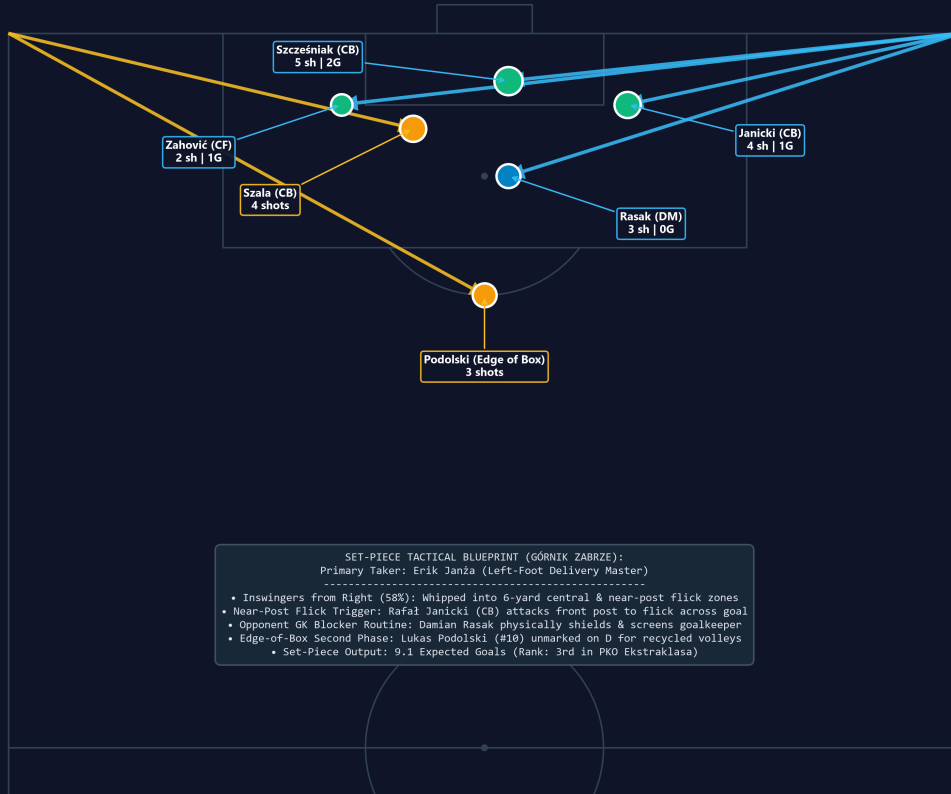
TACTICAL EVALUATION & DECISION INSIGHTS:

- Peak Threat Zone:** Expected Threat reaches +0.42 xT in the left half-space 25-35m out, corresponding to Lukas Podolski's playmaking sector.
- Zone 14 Funnel:** Rather than wild crosses, Górnik systematically feeds Zone 14 before sliding low cutbacks across the 6-yard box.
- Tactical Instruction:** Deploy a dedicated defensive anchor to eliminate Podolski's turn-and-shoot window in the left halfspace.

PEAK SECTOR xT
+0.42 (Left Half)ZONE 14 xT
+0.38FLANK VS CENTER
THREAT
61% vs 39%MODEL ENGINE
Karun Singh xTRESOLUTION
12x8 Grid

GÓRNIK ZABRZE | SET-PIECE & CORNER DELIVERY ANALYSIS

Pre-Match Coach's Report: Delivery Trajectories, First-Contact Targets & Routines



Cyan: Inswinging deliveries | Amber: Outswinging deliveries | Visual by Zafer Yorganci

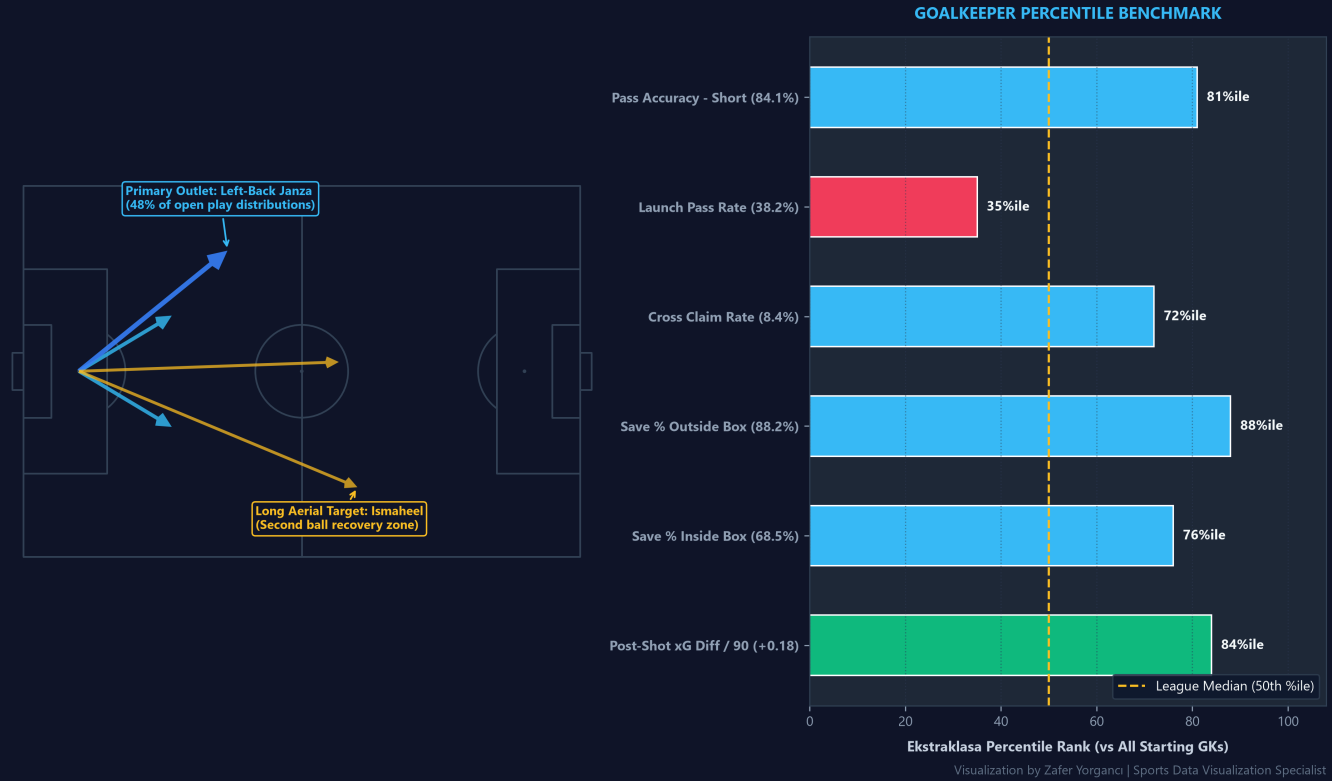
TACTICAL EVALUATION & DECISION INSIGHTS:

- Inswinging Danger:** Erik Janža's left-footed inswingers from the right target the central 6-yard box (5 shots, 2 goals) and near-post flick (Janicki).
- Screening Routine:** Damian Rasak deliberately blocks the opposing goalkeeper's jump trajectory on corner deliveries.
- Second-Phase Danger:** Lukas Podolski stays stationed on the edge of the box (the D) for cleared balls to execute direct volleys.

SET-PIECE XG
9.1 xG (Rank 3rd)PRIMARY DELIVERY
Inswinger (58%)FIRST CONTACT TARGET
Szczesniak (CB)NEAR POST TARGET
Janicki (CB)EDGE SHOOTER
Podolski (#10)

GOALKEEPER PROFILE & DISTRIBUTION CHANNELS: FILIP MAJCHROWICZ

Pre-Match Opposition Tactical Scouting: Pass Trajectories & Shot-Stopping Profile



TACTICAL EVALUATION & DECISION INSIGHTS:

- Distribution Tendency:** 48% of open-play distributions flow to left-back Janža; high presses must curve runs to cut this lateral outlet.
- Long Launch Weakness:** Long kicks down the right flank yield a low 38% aerial duel win rate; contesting these second balls wins possession.
- Shot-Stopping Strength:** Ranks top quartile with +0.18 Post-Shot xG prevented per 90; elite against perimeter shots, vulnerable to rapid rebounds.

PSXG DIFF / 90
+0.18BOX SAVE %
68.5%CROSS CLAIM %
8.4%PRIMARY OUTLET
LB Janža (48%)LONG LAUNCH %
38.2%

Shot Map, xG Constellation & Cumulative Flow (2-1 Legia)

Tactical Execution Verification, Finishing Zones & Momentum Shifts

GÓRNIK ZABRZE | SHOT MAP & xG CONSTELLATION

Fixture: Górnik Zabrze 2-1 Legia Warszawa | 14 Shots, 2.15 xG Created



MATCH SUMMARY: GÓRNIK 2 - 1 LEGIA			
Arena Zabrze Ekstraklasa 2025-2026			
Metric	Górnik	Legia	
Shots (On Target)	14 (5)	10 (4)	
Expected Goals (xG)	2.15	1.18	
xG per Shot	0.154	0.118	
Big Chances	3	1	
Field Tilt %	54.2%	45.8%	

● Goal ● Saved ● Blocked ● Off Target

Bubble size proportional to Expected Goals (xG) | Visualization by Zafer Yorganci

TACTICAL EVALUATION & DECISION INSIGHTS:

- Shot Quality Dominance:** Górnik achieved 0.154 xG/shot vs Legia's 0.118, creating 3 big chances in the central golden zone.
- Decisive Finishes:** Zahović (27', 0.38 xG cutback) and Podolski (81', 0.45 xG high turnover thunderbolt) sealed victory.
- Takeaway for Coaches:** Restricting Górnik's transition triggers limits their shot volume from 14 shots down to single digits.

FINAL SCORE

2 - 1 Win

TOTAL xG

2.15 vs 1.18

xG / SHOT

0.154

BIG CHANCES

3 vs 1

MOMENTUM PEAK

+0.9 (Late 2nd H)